



NCL Luna — Eastern Caribbean Solo Group

May 16 – 23, 2026 · Tina Maulsby, host

Ship: Norwegian Luna · **Sailing from:** Terminal B, PortMiami · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, NCL's quirks, and the group rhythm.

Day by day

#	Date	Port	Hours ashore	Tender	The one thing
1	Sat May 16	PortMiami — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:00 PM; depart 4:00 PM	—	All-aboard 3 PM. Sailaway past Star Island and Government Cut.
2	Sun May 17	Cruising at sea	—	—	Settling-in day. Studio Lounge meet-and-greet for solos.
3	Mon May 18	Puerto Plata, DR	7:00 AM – 3:00 PM	dock at Amber Cove	Damajagua waterfalls or the Amber Cove pool day.
4	Tue May 19	St. Thomas, USVI	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM	dock at Crown Bay or WICO	Magens Bay beach taxi (\$12 r/t), or ferry to St. John.
5	Wed May 20	Tortola, BVI	6:45 AM – 2:00 PM (early!)	dock at Pier Park	Cane Garden Bay (~\$15 taxi r/t). Tightest day — back by 1:30.
6	Thu May 21	Cruising at sea	—	—	Recovery day. Specialty dinners book up — walk-up at 4 PM.
7	Fri May 22	Great Stirrup Cay	10:00 AM – 6:00 PM	tender	NCL's private island, mid-redevelopment. Beach + buffet.
8	Sat May 23	PortMiami — debarkation	off by 7:00 AM (early!)	—	Uber to MIA \$30–45. Long debark; allow margin.

Hudson's dinner is the group rhythm — Tina's group eats at Hudson's (Deck 8) every evening at 5:30 PM. Show up to whichever nights work for you. Free with your fare.

Tortola is the tight day: 6:45 AM arrival, 2:00 PM departure. If you want shore time, set an alarm. Back by 1:30 PM.

Passport strongly preferred. St. Thomas + Tortola have different documentation expectations even though they're geographically close.

Currency aboard: USD. **Auto-gratuity:** \$20/day per person at most cabins; \$25/day Suites/Haven.

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on your real drinking pattern, the [budget-calculator](#) for the total-fare picture, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for auto-grats + cash tips — mid-sail upgrades cost more per day and give you fewer days of usage.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Friday recommended, Saturday required

Friday May 15 — fly in. Same-day flights to a 3:00 PM all-aboard are risky. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach gives you margin.

Saturday May 16 — embarkation.

- **Terminal: Terminal B, PortMiami** (NCL’s regular Miami berth).
- **MIA → Terminal B:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → Terminal B:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min.
- **If driving:** Terminal AA garage **\$35/day** (~\$245/week, firsthand May 2026 — verify); other terminals similar. Offsite Miami long-term lots \$7–14/day with shuttle.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:00 PM. **All-aboard 3:00 PM.** Ship departs ~4:00 PM.
- **NCL online check-in** — complete in the NCL app before arrival.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall with color-coded tag by ~11 PM.
- **5:30 – 7:00 AM:** Breakfast at Indulge Food Hall or Surfside Café.
- **6:30 AM:** Customs clearance complete. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:00 – 9:30 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on with you: change of clothes, all medications, passport, phone charger, valuables.

Getting from PortMiami to MIA. Uber/Lyft on Saturday morning, **\$30–45, 25–30 minutes**. Surge pricing is real; pre-book if possible.

Killing 4–6 hours before an evening flight:

- **Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace** — 10-min walk from the terminal.
- **Pérez Art Museum (PAMM)** — 15-min walk. \$20 entry. Air-conditioned.
- **Brickell** — short Uber. Cuban coffee, lunch, Uber to MIA when ready.

Airport-arrival timing.

Flight	Leave PortMiami by
Domestic, after 4 PM	1:30 PM
International, after 6 PM	2:30 PM

MIA TSA lines run 30–60 min during Saturday cruise-return rush.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — Luna spots worth knowing

- **The Penrose Atrium** — Luna's three-deck central gathering space; the orienting landmark and group-gathering venue.
- **Indulge Food Hall** — included quick-casual; multiple stations. The right call when you don't want to commit to a sit-down meal.
- **Ocean Boulevard** — outdoor wraparound walkway on Deck 8. Sailaway viewing and sunrise coffee.
- **Aqua Slidecoaster** — the signature attraction; first hour after opening has zero line.
- **Mandara Spa thermal-suite day pass** — sea-day intro rates appear.
- **Studio Lounge** (Deck 11) — solo-cabin perk. Hosted coffee hour Day 2 morning typically.
- **Penrose Bar** — Tina's gathering spot some evenings; check group communications.

Sea-day priorities (Day 2 + Day 6)

1. **Sunrise on Ocean Boulevard** — best 30 minutes of the week.
2. **Solo Studio meet-and-greet** Day 2 — NCL hosts this; check the daily program for time.
3. **Aqua Slidecoaster** in the first hour it opens.
4. **Thermal suite at Mandara Spa** — sea-day morning intro rate.
5. **Specialty dining reservation** for Day 6 night (the last sea day) — Cagney's, Le Bistro, Palomar, Onda by Scarpetta all fill.

Specialty dining picks

- **Cagney's Steakhouse** — the included-line steakhouse standard. Good for a celebration night.
- **Le Bistro** — French. The most romantic specialty room on NCL ships.
- **Onda by Scarpetta** — modern Italian, partnership with Scott Conant.
- **Palomar** — Mediterranean-Latin fusion.
- **Sukhothai + Hasuki** — Asian; Teppanyaki room is the showy hibachi seating.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Puerto Plata** — Damajagua 27 Waterfalls (~\$95 ship excursion; \$60 indep) for the adventurer, or stay at Amber Cove's pool day for the easier choice.
- **St. Thomas** — Magens Bay beach taxi (~\$12 r/t per person) is the highest-value low-stress day. Skykart from Mountain Top is the splurge.
- **Tortola** — Cane Garden Bay taxi (~\$15 r/t); back by 1:30 PM for the 2:00 PM all-aboard. The Baths on Virgin Gorda is the postcard but only via a tightly-scheduled ship excursion.
- **Great Stirrup Cay** — NCL's private island under redevelopment. Tender required. Beach + buffet day; manage expectations on amenity completeness.

Where Tina sets the rhythm

- **Day 1 sailaway** — Penrose Bar typically; verify Tina's communications.
- **Hudson's 5:30 PM nightly** — the recurring group dinner; show up when you want.
- **Studio Lounge** — solo cruisers cluster here regardless of who's hosting.

Photo spots worth knowing

- **Sailaway from Ocean Boulevard Deck 8** — Star Island superyachts, Miami skyline at golden hour.
- **The Penrose Atrium** at evening — three-deck chandelier moment.
- **Cane Garden Bay** — curve of white sand with the BVI hills behind.
- **Magens Bay** — top-ranked beach panorama.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc — ask Tina or download from [In the Wake](#). The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.